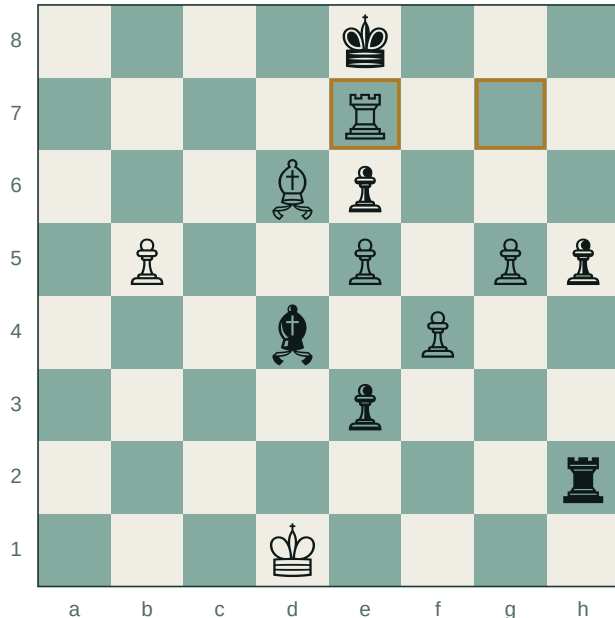


Discovered checks: Black, move 35

Discovered checks

Black to move



Previous move: 35.Re7+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

35...Kd8 36. Rc7 e2+ 37. Ke1 Bf2+ 38. Kxe2 Bb6+

35...Kd8 The king moves from e8 to d8. Recorded reply: **36.Rc7**.

36...e2+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **37.Ke1**.

37...Bf2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **38.Kxe2**.

38...Bb6+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. The changed line means the rook on h2 attacks the king on e2.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by -1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -1: the balance goes from -1 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A discovered check opens a line toward the king by moving the blocking piece. Because check must be answered, the moving piece may gain a free tempo for another threat.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on d1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.